AON

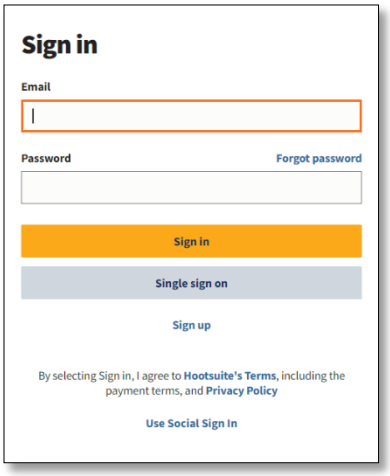
# Creating and Scheduling Social Media Posts on Hootsuite

Quick Guide

Digital Marketing Center of Excellence

This quick guide will provide you with a brief overview of creating and scheduling posts on social media through Hootsuite. These quick seven steps will be useful if you are already knowledgeable about publishing on social media and would simply like general guidance on how to perform publish and schedule posts via Hootsuite. For a complete walkthrough, click here.

## Step 1: Log in to Hootsuite

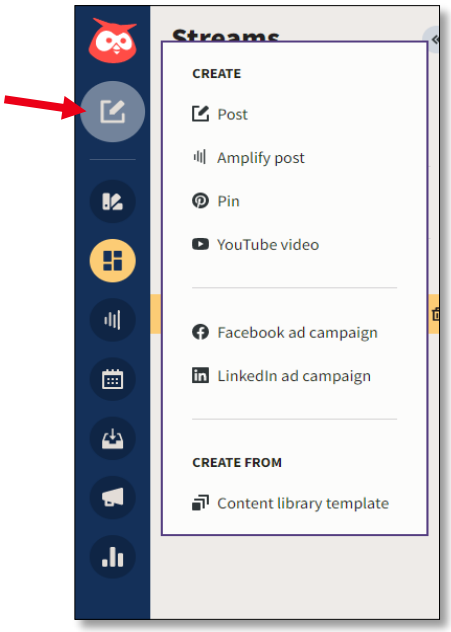



If you do not have access to the platform, please fill out the Aon Social Media Access Request Form to request access. As there are limited seats for Hootsuite, we'll need to understand your use case for the platform.

NOTE: Please ensure you request access via your individual email IDs and not group IDs (such as marketing@aon.com)

Once you confirm access, log in to the Hootsuite account.

## Step 2: Navigate to Composer




To create a post, navigate to the Composer, and hover on the first icon, which auto-opens the list of sub-topics. Click on Post to allow Hootsuite to open the Composer board with options to create copy, creative and tags.

## Step 3: Composer

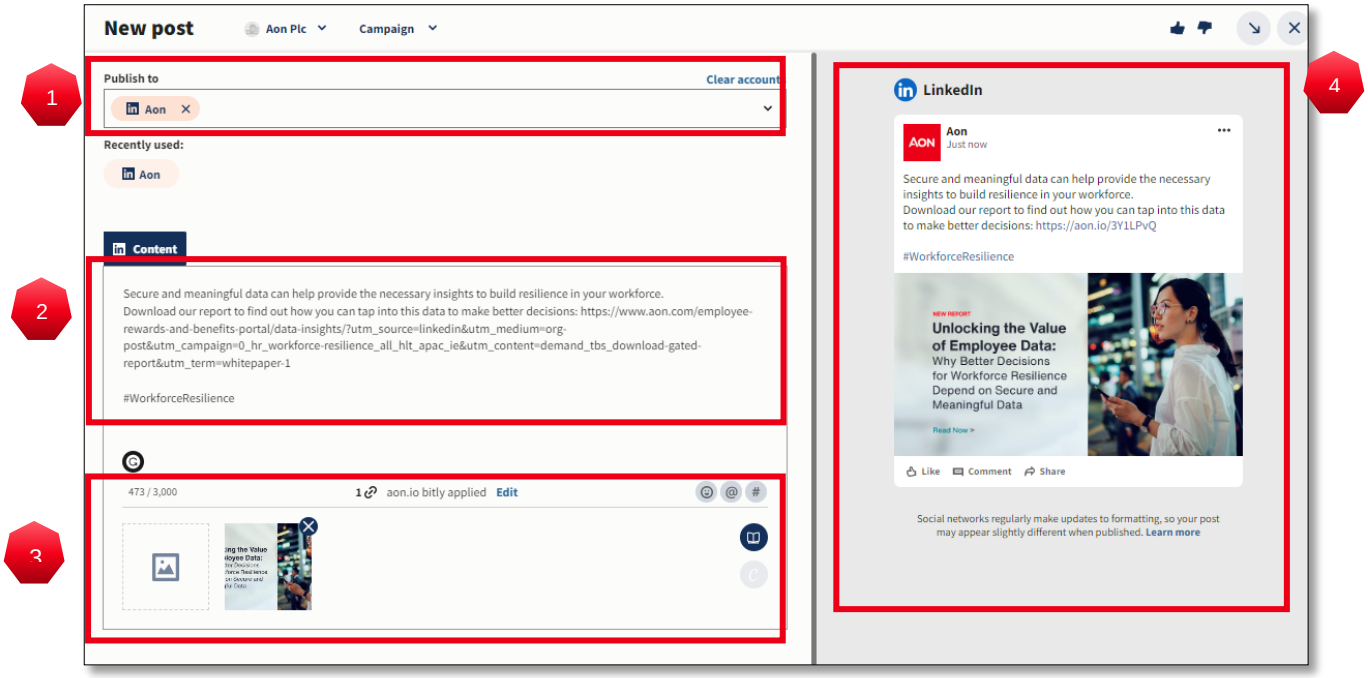
The Composer on Hootsuite contains all the vital elements required to create a post.

It provides a drop-down of all the social channels, the copy container, the creative, tagging and targeting pieces. It also dynamically generates a preview for reviewing the final post before publishing the piece of content.

# Step 4: Adding Copy and Creative

1. **Publish to:** Select the page/ where you would like to publish the post. It is recommended that one page is selected at a time. Selecting multiple platforms will lead to issues such as auto cropping of creatives, and character restriction differences, among other inconsistencies. If a colleague wishes to publish the same post on multiple pages, then duplicating the post is preferred.

2. **Content**: Add the approved copy to the content box, along with the call-to-action link (Using the Internal UTM Builder) and relevant hashtags.




3. **Image / Creative:** Similar to LinkedIn or Facebook, Hootsuite auto fetches the image (i.e., Open Graph/Twitter Card) and dynamically generates based on the link. If the image is missing or isn't suitable, try uploading an image or social tile directly to the post.

4. **Preview:** This enables you to do a final proof. It depicts the exact image proportions and copy that will be published. Colleagues will also notice that the long-form link will be automatically replaced by a Vanity URL or Shortlink.

**External links to image and video requirements for reference.**

**NOTE**:

**a.** All links to Aon.com must be UTM tagged to ensure correct data pipelines and flow into the global analytics dashboard.

**b.** Tagging personal profiles isn't available on Hootsuite. If you need to tag a personal profile, this will need to be edited manually and directly on the platform (LinkedIn, Facebook etc..)

**c.** Uploading carousels on LinkedIn isn't available on Hootsuite. Uploading multiple images is published as an image group, not a carousel. If colleagues need to post a carousel, this will need to be created directly on the platform. LinkedIn carousal posts would need to be compiled as a PDF- with one image per tile, as opposed to uploading a group of images.

# Step 5: Adding Tags and Targeting

**Tagging**

Adding tags to posts helps colleagues export ready made reports of campaigns, particular posts or topics.

Tagging lets you categorise your post around elements such as **Campaign** (buyer) and **Market** (location). These tags are not visible to the public and do not influence placement. These tags are for your benefit and ease of finding your campaigns through categorisation. The Digital Peformance team recommends using the aforementioned tags at a minimum. The analytics dashboard maps with these tags and can be filtered out with the dates.

## Targeting

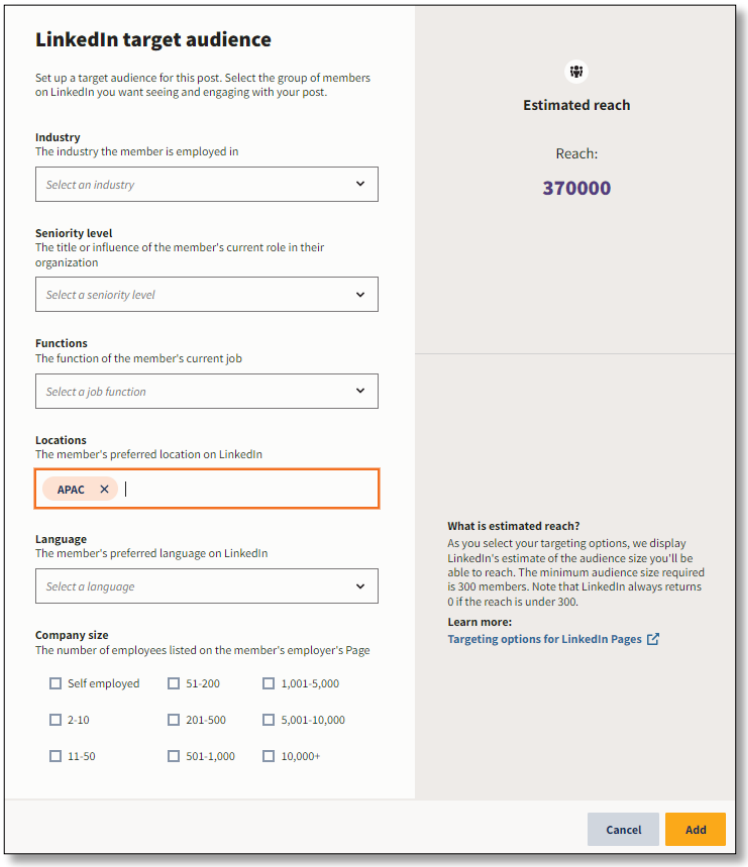
Targeting is an essential step and will influence your placement. All posts must be assigned a target location to avoid posting and publishing globally. Global posts are strictly restricted and require approval from the Global Media team.

Audience targeting options will change based on the platform selected – LinkedIn will enable more profession-based targeting while Facebook will have more personal trait targeting available.

For example, if selecting LinkedIn, colleagues can add additional targeting by Industry, Seniority, Job Functions, Locations, Languages and Employee Size of the companies the audience belongs to. The more filters are applied, the Estimated Reach becomes smaller. Once done, click on 'Add'

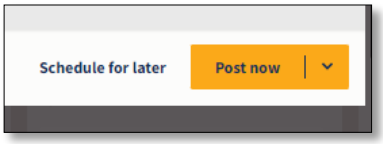
**NOTE**: This data is directly connected to the platforms and gives an estimate of the filtered audience that follows the selected page (since this is an organic post).

Example: We have selected the LinkedIn platform for the Aon Official Page. Upon selecting the APAC region, the reach of the audience is estimated to be 370,000.

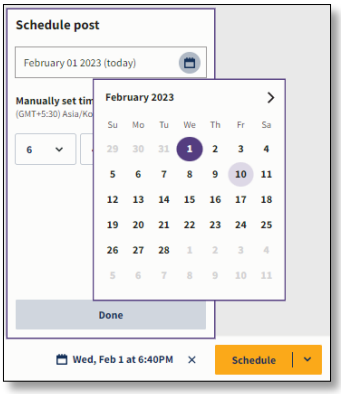


# Step 6: Scheduling or Publishing the post

After completing steps 1 to 5, the next step is to Schedule for later or Post Now.




Clicking on Post Now publishes the post immediately.




If you do not want to post immediately, you will need to schedule a post. To schedule a post, click on 'Schedule for Later' and a pop-up window will open up.

**NOTE**: 'Publish Now' posts do not appear in the planner. Scheduling posts can be done for those that are being scheduled for or after 10 minutes of the time of setting up.

This window has the option to schedule a date and select a time.

To update your Timezone, Select **My profile**, and then click **Account settings**, **preferences, and billing**. On the Hootsuite main navigation with **Profile** selected, scroll down to the **Time Zone** section, select your time zone from the list, and then select **Save Account Info**.

# Step 7: Posts on Planner

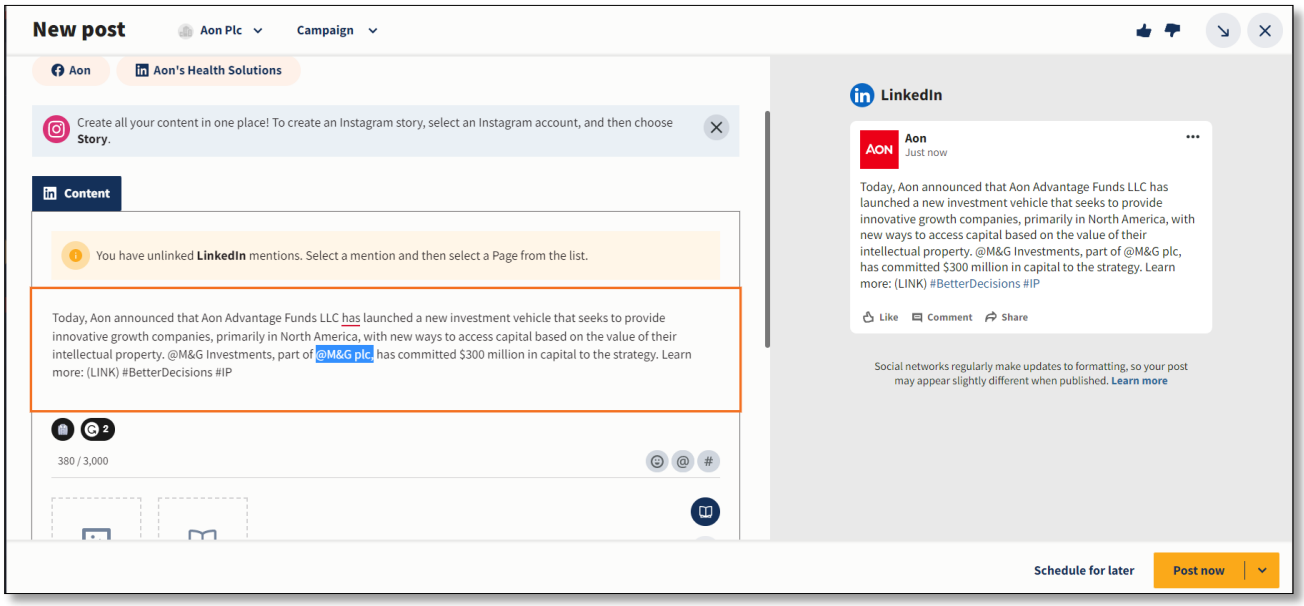
This step is another method to proof and review scheduled posts only. As soon as a post is scheduled, it is pushed to the Planner section of Hootsuite. This planner section has monthly, daily and weekly views. Colleagues can filter the planner based on the assigned tags when creating a post. Colleagues can filter posts based on tags added during 'Composing' of the posts.

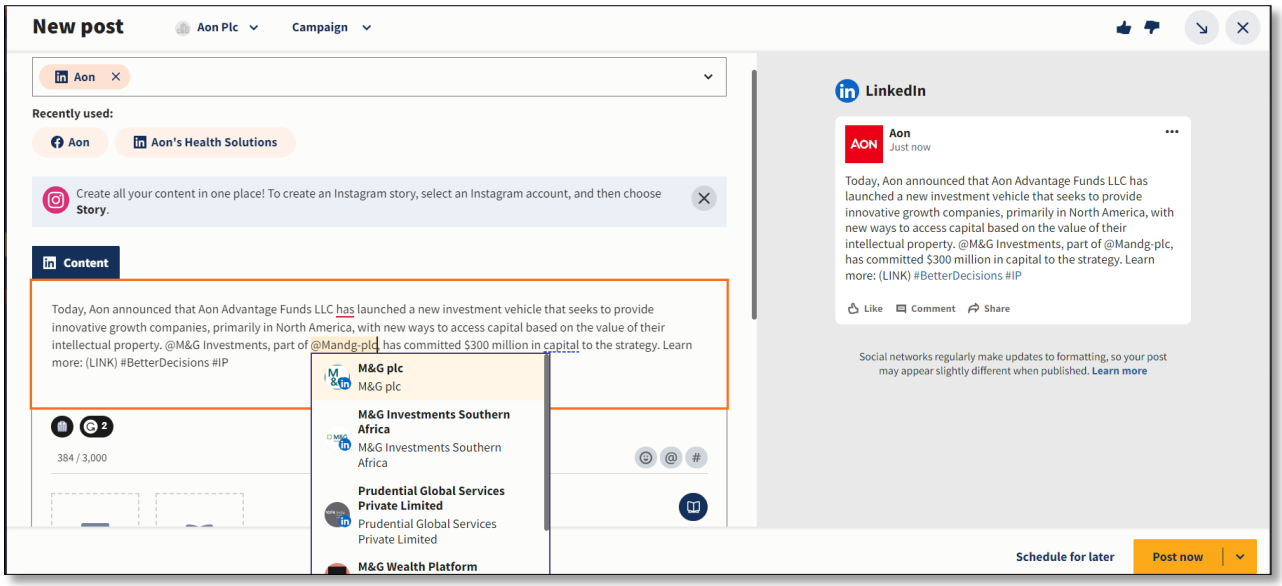
Colleagues can go to the date of the scheduled post and re-check the preview. Users can also directly open the Composer and edit the post. From here, a post can be duplicated or rescheduled, before publishing.

**Congratulations! You have now successfully created and published/scheduled a post!**

# Troubleshooting tags on Hootsuite

If you or a colleague experience issues tagging a company when creating content, please be advised of the following:




The Hootsuite tagging system does not recognize non-character items. If you copy and paste or type in a company name with characters other than letters, you'll notice it won't locate the company and therefore that company will not be tagged correctly.

Instead, type out the full company name without the non-characters. For example, when tagging company m&g-plc, it should be spelled out, m*and*g-plc. This will prompt the system to provide a list which can help locate and tag the company correctly.

## Hootsuite file requirements

In the links below, you will find information on file types and sizes accepted by Hootsuite.

**Note**: LinkedIn does not support PDFs or other documents from third parties like Hootsuite. Any PDFs you wish to post to a targeted audience should be uploaded directly through LinkedIn.

Click here to learn more about image file requirements including accepted formats for each individual platform. For more information on video file requirements click here.

# Need More Help?

Please reach out to the Digital Performance team for organic social platform (LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook, Instagram, etc.) governance, SOPs, best practices, & performance improvement.